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June 29, 1984

INTERIM FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

CHICKEN STEW, THERMOSTABILIZED, TRAY PACK

This interim Federal specification was developed by the U.S. Army Natick Research and Development Center, Natick, MA 01760, based upon currently available technical information. It is recommended that Federal agencies use it in procurement and forward recommendations for changes to the preparing activity at the address shown above.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification covers chicken stew thermostabilized in tray pack cans for use by the Department of Defense as a component of operational rations.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

Federal Specifications:

TT-C-495	-	Coatings, Exterior, For Tinned Food Cans
PPP-B-636	-	Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal specifications, standards, and commercial item descriptions as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications, Standards and Commercial Item Descriptions. The Index, which includes cumulative bimonthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20250.)

(Single copies of this specification, other Federal specifications, and commercial item descriptions required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge from General Services Administration Business Service Centers in Boston, MA; New York, NY; Philadelphia, PA; Washington, DC; Atlanta, GA; Chicago, IL; Kansas City, MO; Forth Worth, TX; Houston, TX; Denver, CO; San Francisco, CA; Los Angeles, CA; and Seattle, WA.

FSC 8940

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(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal standardization documents, and the Index of Federal Specifications, Standards and Commercial Item Descriptions from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Specifications:

MIL-L-1497	-	Labeling of Metal Cans for Subsistence Items
MIL-L-35078	-	Loads, Unit: Preparation of Nonperishable Subsistence Items; General Specification For

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-129	-	Marking for Shipment and Storage
MIL-STD-900	-	Bacterial Standards for Starches, Flours, Cereals, Alimentary Pastes, Dry Milks and Sugars Used in the Preparation of Canned Foods for the Armed Services

(Copies of Military specifications and standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

Laws and Regulations:

U.S. Department of Health and Human Services

Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and Regulations Promulgated Thereunder (21 CFR Parts 1-199)

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20250.)

U.S. Department of Agriculture (USDA)

Poultry Products Inspection Regulations

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20250.)

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U.S. Standards for Grades of Frozen Carrots
U.S. Standards for Grades of Frozen Peas

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Chief, Processed Products Branch, Fruit and Vegetable Division, Agricultural Marketing Service, U.S. Department of Agriculture, Washington, DC 20250.)

U.S. Standards for Condition of Food Containers

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Director, Market Research and Development Division, Agricultural Marketing Service, U.S. Department of Agriculture, Washington, DC 20250.)

Environmental Protection Agency (EPA)

National Interim Primary Drinking Water Regulations

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Office of Drinking Water WH550, Environmental Protection Agency, Washington, DC 20460.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless a specific issue is identified, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply.

Association of Official Analytical Chemists (AOAC)

Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Analytical Chemists

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Association of Official Analytical Chemists, 1111 North 19th Street, Suite 210, Arlington, VA 22209.)

American Dehydrated Onion and Garlic Association

Official Standards and Methods of the American Dehydrated Onion and Garlic Association (ADOGA) for Dehydrated Onion and Garlic Products

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Dehydrated Onion and Garlic Association, 251 Kearney Street, #410, San Francisco, CA 94108.)

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American Public Health Association

Standard Methods for the Examination of Dairy Products

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Public Health Association, 1015 18th Street, N.W. Washington, DC 20036.)

National Academy of Sciences

Food Chemicals Codex

(Application for copies should be addressed to the National Academy Press, 2101 Constitution Avenue, N.W., Washington, DC 20418.)

(Industry association specifications and standards are generally available for reference from libraries. They are also distributed among technical groups and using Federal agencies.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 First article. When specified, a sample shall be subjected to first article inspection (see 4.3, 6.1, and 6.3).

3.2 Ingredients. All ingredients shall be clean, sound, wholesome, and free from foreign material, evidence of rodent or insect infestation, extraneous material, off-odors, off-flavors, and off-colors.

3.2.1 Chicken. The chicken shall be prepared from chilled or frozen (ready-to-cook) fowl (mature female chicken). The chicken shipped between plants shall be accompanied by a USDA Grading Branch Certificate, certifying class and condition of product.

3.2.1.1 Chilled chicken. Chicken received in the chilled state shall not be previously frozen and shall have been held at a temperature not to exceed 40°F for a period of time not to exceed 4 days following initial chilling and prior to preparation and further processing (see 3.3). The chicken shipped between plants shall be accompanied by a USDA Grading Branch Certificate, certifying initial chilling date.

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3.2.1.2 Frozen chicken. Raw (uncooked) chickens received in the frozen state shall have been held at a temperature not to exceed 0°F for a period of time not to exceed 75 days following initial freezing and prior to preparation and further processing (see 3.3). The chicken shipped between plants shall be accompanied by a USDA Grading Branch Certificate, certifying the initial freezing (in-storage) date.

3.2.1.3 Precooked, frozen chicken. Precooked frozen chicken mechanically diced with dice setting at approximately 3/4 by 3/4 by 3/4 inch may be purchased. In this case, conditions in 3.2.1 and 3.2.1.1 shall apply prior to cooking. The cooked dices shall be frozen to 0°F within 72 hours, packaged and sealed in water impermeable material having an oxygen permeability of not more than 10 cc of O_2 per square meter per 24 hours per mil thickness at 73°F and 0 percent relative humidity. The packaged frozen chicken dices shall have been held at 0°F or below for a period not to exceed 30 days prior to tray pack filling (see 3.4).

3.2.2 Potatoes. Potatoes shall be fresh and of one of the varieties suitable for canning. The maximum specific gravity for the potatoes shall be 1.075 with a reducing sugar content of not more than 2.0 percent on a dry weight basis. The potatoes shall be U.S. No. 1 grade of the U.S. Standards for Grades of White Potatoes and shall be of the latest season's crop. Dehydro-frozen potatoes may be used in lieu of fresh potatoes and shall comply with the same dice size as the fresh potatoes.

3.2.3 Carrots.

a. Fresh carrots. The carrots shall be fresh, clean, sound, mature, and of good typical color. The carrots shall be Danvers, Red-Cored Chatenay or similar varieties with comparable quality suitable for canning.

b. Frozen carrots. The carrots shall be U.S. Grade A of the U.S. Standards for Grades of Frozen Carrots, and shall be of the latest season's crop.

3.2.4 Chicken broth. Chicken broth may be purchased frozen or canned (thermostabilized). The broth shall be clear, essentially fat free with percent solids sufficient to comply with the solids requirement in the sauce formulation (see 3.3.3). The broth shall have a characteristic mild-chicken-broth odor and flavor and may contain flavor enhancers approved by FDA. The chicken broth shall be produced in a USDA inspected plant in accordance with USDA regulations and when frozen shall have been held at 0°F or below for a period not to exceed 75 days prior to sauce formulation (see 3.3.3).

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3.2.5 Chicken fat. Frozen chicken fat shall be purchased. The chicken fat shall have a characteristic clear yellow color, chicken-fat odor and flavor. The chicken fat may contain antioxidants approved by the Food Safety Inspection Service (FSIS) of USDA. The chicken fat shall have a peroxide value not to exceed 6 meq./kg., a free fatty acid value not to exceed 0.50 percent as oleic acid, and a moisture content not to exceed 0.25 percent. The chicken fat shall be produced in a USDA inspected plant in accordance with USDA regulations and shall have been held at 0°F or below for a period not to exceed 75 days prior to sauce formulation (see 3.3.3).

3.2.6 Starch, modified, high opacity. The high opacity starch shall be white, odorless, finely pulverized modified maize food starch for use in canned foods. The modified starch shall demonstrate initial viscosity development in the temperature range 140°-170°F and a typical viscosity (be fully hydrated) at common retort temperatures. The starch shall resist breakdown at low pH, under shear stress and conditions of cold storage. The starch shall be bland with essentially no cereal or starch taste and shall comply with MIL-STD-900.

3.2.7 Peas, green.

a. Fresh green peas. Peas shall be fresh, sweet, green peas of a single variety suitable for canning. The peas shall be well formed, bright, clean, young and tender and of such size as not to pass through a 9/32-inch sieve but will pass through a 12/32-inch sieve once shelled. The peas shall be free from soft rot and damage.

b. Frozen green peas. Frozen green peas shall comply with the requirements for U.S. Grade A or better of the U.S. Standard for Grades of Frozen Peas and shall be of the latest season's crop.

3.2.8 Water. Water used for formulation and washing shall conform to the National Interim Primary Drinking Water Regulations.

3.2.9 Cream cheese, fresh. The fresh cream cheese shall meet the FDA Standard of Identity for Cream Cheese. The cream cheese shall have a delicate butter-like or creamy flavor and shall be moderately salted. The body and texture shall not be coarse, crumbly, excessively smooth, gummy, grainy, overfirm or too soft. The cream cheese shall be in excellent condition, free of mold, slime, discoloration, or burnt particles.

3.2.10 Shortening, vegetable, powdered. Powdered vegetable shortening shall be spray dried, free flowing, and free from burnt or scorched aroma. The shortening shall be composed of partially hydrogenated vegetable oil, sodium caseinate, corn syrup solids, soy protein isolate, dipotassium phosphate, sodium

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silico aluminate, tricalcium phosphate with or without antioxidants. The shortening shall meet the following chemical analyses: Total oil 75 ± 2.5 percent; protein 5.5 ± 0.5 percent; pH 7.5 ± 0.5; moisture 1.5 ± 0.5 percent; carbohydrate 16 ± 1.0 percent; ash 2.0 ± 1.0 percent.

3.2.11 Onions, chopped, dehydrated. The dehydrated chopped onions shall be Fancy Grade as defined in the Official Standards and Methods of the American Dehydrated Onion and Garlic Association (ADOGA) for Dehydrated Onion and Garlic Products.

3.2.12 Celery, sliced, dehydrated. The dehydrated celery slices shall be obtained from clean, sound Pascal type celery. The slices shall be approximately 3/8 inch cross-cut stalk slices with no leaf cuts. The slices shall be free flowing with a uniform bright color. The dehydrated celery shall have a moisture content not in excess of 4.5 percent and a sulphur dioxide content of 750 ± 250 ppm.

3.2.13 Salt. Salt shall be non-iodized, free flowing, white, refined, sodium chloride with or without anti-caking agents.

3.2.14 Lecithin. Lecithin shall comply with the requirements in the Food Chemicals Codex.

3.2.15 Pepper, white, ground. Ground white pepper shall be derived from the dried mature berries of Piper nigrum L. from which the outer covering or the outer and inner coverings have been removed. The pepper shall have a characteristic, penetrating odor, a hot biting pungent flavor and a light color. The ground white pepper shall contain not less than 1.0 mL of volatile oil per 100 grams of ground white pepper and be of such size that not less than 95 percent shall pass through a U.S. Standard No. 40 sieve.

3.2.16 Bay leaves, ground. Ground bay leaves shall be derived from the dried leaves of Laurus nobilis L. The bay leaves shall possess a pleasant aromatic odor and pungent, mildy bitter flavor with a pale green to yellow green color. A minimum of 95 percent shall pass through a U.S. Standard No. 30 sieve. Volatile oil content shall be not less than 1.0 mL of volatile oil per 100 grams of ground bay leaves.

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3.2.17 Sage, ground. Ground sage shall be the dried leaves of Salvia officinalis L. It shall be green to grayish green in color and have a strong, fragrant and aromatic odor, and a slightly bitter taste. The sage shall contain not less than 1.0 mL of volatile oil per 100 grams of ground sage and be of such size that not less than 95 percent shall pass through a U.S. Standard No. 20 sieve.

3.2.18 Thyme, ground. Ground thyme shall be derived from the dried leaves and flavoring tops of Thymus vulgaris L. and shall have a fragrant, aromatic odor and minty flavor. The thyme shall contain not less than 0.8 mL of volatile oil per 100 grams of ground thyme and be of such size that not less than 95 percent shall pass through a U.S. Standard No. 30 sieve.

3.2.19 Allspice, ground. Ground allspice shall be derived from dried, nearly ripe fruit of Pimenta officinalis Lindl and shall have a fragrant, clove-like aroma, strongly aromatic, pungent, clove-like flavor and a dark reddish-brown color. Allspice shall contain not less than 3.0 mL of volatile oil per 100 grams of ground allspice with 80.0 percent eugenol as a principal constituent. A minimum of 95 percent, by weight, shall pass through a U.S. Standard No. 25 sieve.

3.2.20 Preblended spice and seasoning mixture. Preblended spices and seasonings may be used. The spices and seasonings in the mixture shall comply with the requirements of this document. The containers used for the spice and seasoning blend shall be labeled with each ingredient and the percentage of each ingredient in the blend. The ingredients shall be in the same proportions as specified in the ingredient formula.

3.3 Preparation and further processing.

3.3.1 Preparation of the chicken. The chicken shall be prepared as follows:

a. The chicken shall be made boneless and skinless and trimmed of all tendons, cartilage, large blood vessels, blood clots, discolorations, bruises, blemishes, feathers and hair. The chicken shall be cooked by water cooking, roasting or steaming. The broth for cooking the chicken may be used in the sauce preparation in the amount and in compliance with the solids content as required. The chicken shall consist by weight of not less than 50 percent but not more than 60 percent white meat and not less than 40 percent but not more than 50 percent dark meat.

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b. The cooked chicken shall be cooled to 40°F or below immediately following the cooking process and held at that temperature or lower for not longer than 48 hours prior to filling.

c. The cooked chicken meat shall be mechanically diced with dice settings at approximately 3/4 by 3/4 by 3/4 inch.

3.3.2 Preparation of the potatoes and carrots.

3.3.2.1 Preparation of potatoes. The fresh potatoes shall be thoroughly cleaned to remove dark and extraneous material, peeled, trimmed and thoroughly washed. The washed potatoes shall be mechanically diced with dicer settings at approximately 3/4 by 3/4 by 3/4 inch and the dices blanched sufficiently to prevent discoloration and to remove excess air in the potato dices. The blanched potatoes shall be immediately cooled in cold water. When dehydro-frozen potato dices are used, they shall be fully rehydrated prior to filling into the tray pack cans. Following blanching or rehydration (as applicable), the potatoes shall be handled in a manner to prevent discoloration. The potato dices shall be filled within 4 hours after blanching (fresh potatoes) or rehydration (dehydro-frozen potatoes).

3.3.2.2 Preparation of carrots. The carrots shall be thoroughly cleaned to remove soil and other foreign material and sorted to remove any which are diseased or otherwise damaged. The sound stock shall be peeled and trimmed to remove discolored, damaged or undesirable portions and thoroughly washed. The washed carrots shall be mechanically diced with dicer settings at approximately 3/8 by 3/8 by 3/8 inch and the dices blanched sufficiently to prevent discoloration and to remove excess air in the carrot dices. The blanched carrots shall be immediately cooled in cold water. Following blanching, the carrots shall be handled in a manner to prevent discoloration. The carrot dices shall be filled within 4 hours after blanching.

3.3.3 Preparation of the sauce. The sauce shall be formulated as follows:

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Ingredients	Percent by weight
Chicken broth (3.0 to 3.5% solids)	75.20
Starch, modified, high opacity	5.50
Chicken fat	4.00
Cream cheese	4.00
Onions, chopped, dehyrated	3.75
Peas, green	3.00
Powdered vegetable shortening	2.00
Salt	1.15
Celery, sliced, dehydrated	1.00
Lecithin	0.25
Pepper, white, ground	0.08
Bay leaf, ground	0.02
Sage, ground	0.02
Thyme, ground	0.02
Allspice, ground	0.01

a. A slurry shall be made using part of the chicken broth, the starch and the powdered vegetable shortening.

b. The remainder of the chicken broth, and the chicken fat and lecithin shall be heated to a boil in a steam jacketed kettle with continuous vigorous agitation to attain the maximum emulsification of the fat into the broth.

c. The cream cheese shall be added and the emulsion stirred until the cheese is melted.

d. The emulsion shall be cooled to 180°F or lower and the remaining ingredients added, except the slurry. The emulsion shall be stirred to assure that the salt is dissolved, the dehydrated vegetables are rehydrated and the spices uniformly dispersed.

e. The slurry shall be added and the final mixture heated to 180° to 190°F and held in this temperature range for 5 minutes.

f. The volume of the final mixture shall be adjusted with water to compensate for evaporation loss during heating and holding.

g. The sauce shall be filled into the tray pack cans within 4 hours after cooking. The temperature of the prepared sauce shall be held at 150°-180°F until filling into the tray cans.

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3.3.4 Preparation of the chicken stew. The chicken, potatoes, carrots, and sauce shall be combined and thoroughly blended in the following proportions prior to filling the tray pack cans.

Ingredient	Percent by weight
Diced chicken	28.30
Diced potatoes (fresh or rehydrated)	11.32
Diced carrots	7.55
Sauce	52.83

3.4 Tray pack filling and sealing. Each tray pack can (see 5.1.1) shall be filled with product such as to conform to the finished product requirements and to the following requirements:

a. The temperature of the chicken stew at time of filling shall be 150°F or greater.

b. Each can shall be hermetically sealed with a minimum of 10 inches (Hg) vacuum immediately after filling.

3.5 Tray pack thermoprocessing. The filled and sealed tray pack cans shall be thermostabilized by retorting at 240°F or below until a sterilization value (F_o) of not less than 6 has been achieved.

3.6 Finished product requirements. The finished product shall comply with the following requirements:

a. There shall be no foreign material, such as but not limited to dirt, insect parts, hair, wood, paper, paint, glass, or metal.

b. There shall be no foreign odor or flavor, such as but not limited to burnt, scorched, stale, sour, rancid, musty, or moldy.

c. There shall be no color foreign to the product.

d. There shall be no bone pieces measuring more than 0.3 inch in any dimension.

e. There shall be no cartilage or section of tendons or ligaments measuring more than 0.3 inch in any dimension.

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f. There shall be no skin, blood clot, bruises, or discolored meat measuring more than 0.3 inch in any dimension.

g. The average net weight shall be 108 ounces minimum.

h. No individual can shall contain less than 106 ounces of product.

i. No individual can shall contain less than 22 ounces of drained recognizable chicken dices.

j. No individual can shall contain less than 16 ounces of drained recognizable potato dices.

k. No individual can shall contain less than 6 ounces of drained carrot dices.

l. No individual can shall contain less than 1 ounce of drained peas.

m. Texture of the chicken dices shall not be dry, rubbery or mushy.

n. Texture of the potatoes shall not be mushy, hard, fibrous or tough.

o. Texture of carrots, peas and other vegetables may be soft (but not mushy), but shall generally retain recognizable shape, and other identifiable characteristics. They shall not be hard, fibrous or tough.

p. Sauce consistency shall be smooth, without lumps and shall not be excessively thick or thin.

q. The average fat content of the finished product shall be not greater than 7.0 percent.

r. The fat content of an individual tray pack shall be not greater than 9.0 percent.

s. The salt content of an individual tray pack shall be not greater than 1.0 percent nor less than 0.5 percent.

3.6.1 Palatability. The product shall be equal to or better than the approved preproduction sample (see 6.1) in palatability and overall appearance.

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3.7 Plant qualification. The poultry component and the finished product shall originate and be produced, processed, and stored in plants regularly operating under Poultry Products Inspection Regulations of the U.S. Department of Agriculture. The dairy component(s) shall originate from a dairy plant which is approved by the Dairy Grading Section, Dairy Division, Agricultural Marketing Service, U.S. Department of Agriculture.

3.8 Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act. All deliveries shall conform in every respect to the provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Contractor's responsibility. Inspection and acceptance by the USDA shall not relieve the contractor of obligation and responsibility to deliver a product complying with all requirements of this specification. The contractor shall assure product compliance prior to submitting the product to the USDA for any inspection.

4.2 Inspection and acceptance service. Product acceptability shall be determined by the USDA. The USDA will determine the degree of acceptance service necessary to assure compliance with the requirements of this specification. The cost of grading and acceptance services performed by the USDA involving inspection, official documentation, and related services shall be borne by the contractor.

4.3 First article inspection. When a first article is required (see 6.1), it shall be inspected in accordance with the quality assurance provisions of this specification and evaluated for overall appearance and palatability. Any failure to conform to the quality assurance provisions of this specification or any appearance or palatability failure shall be cause for rejection of the first article.

4.4 Component and material inspection. Components and materials shall be inspected in accordance with all the requirements of referenced specifications, drawings, and standards unless otherwise excluded, amended, modified, or qualified in this specification or applicable purchase document.

4.4.1 Ingredient and component examination. Conformance of ingredients and components to identity, condition, and other requirements shall be determined by examination of pertinent labels, markings, U.S. Grade certificates, invoices, certificates of analysis, or other valid documents. In addition, each ingredient shall be examined organoleptically as necessary to

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determine conformance to the condition requirements. Any nonconformance to an identity, condition, or other requirement shall be cause for rejection of the ingredient or component lot or of any involved product.

4.5 In-process examination. In-process examination shall be performed to determine conformance to the preparation, processing, can interior coating, filling, sealing, and packing requirements. Any nonconformance revealed by actual examination or by review of records of time, temperature, and formulation or of other valid documents shall be cause for rejection of the involved product.

4.6 Tray pack inspection. The inspection lot shall include only tray packs produced in one workshift. The USDA reserves the right to separate the inspection lot into smaller inspection lots.

4.6.1 Net weight inspection. Randomly select 30 filled and sealed tray pack cans from the inspection lot and weigh separately. Subtract the average tare weight (determined by randomly selecting and weighing 30 of the empty tray pack cans and lids used in preparing the product and dividing the total weight by 30) from the weight of each tray pack in the sample. Results shall be reported to the nearest 1 ounce. If the average net weight is less than 108 ounces or if the net weight of any individual can is less than 106 ounces, the lot shall be rejected.

4.6.2 Product inspection. Eight tray packs shall be selected at random from the lot. The eight tray packs shall be heated for 35 minutes in 180° to 190°F water, opened, and inspected in accordance with table I.

a. If no defects are found, the lot shall be acceptable.

b. If two or more major defects are found, the lot shall be rejected.

c. If only one major defect is found, a second sample of eight tray packs shall be selected at random from the lot, heated as above, and inspected for the defects indicated in table I. If any defect is found in the second sample, the lot shall be rejected.

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TABLE I. Product inspection 1/ 2/

Category	Defect
Major	
151	Presence of bone measuring more than 0.3 inch in any dimension.
152	Presence of cartilage or sections of tendons or ligaments measuring more than 0.3 inch in any dimension.
153	Presence of skin, blood clots, bruise or discolored meat measuring more than 0.3 inch in any dimension.
154	Drained weight of recognizable chicken dices in a can is less than 22 ounces. 3/
155	Drained weight of recognizable potato dices in a can is less than 16 ounces. 3/
156	Drained weight of recognizable carrot dices in a can is less than 6 ounces. 3/
157	Drained weight of peas in a can is less than 1 ounce. 3/
158	Texture of chicken dices dry, rubbery or mushy. 4/
159	Texture of potatoes mushy, hard, fibrous or tough. 4/
160	Texture of carrots, peas and other vegetables hard, mushy, fibrous or tough. 4/
161	Sauce consistency lumpy or is excessively thick or thin.
162	Color not characteristic of the product (materially darkened, scorched or oxidized).

1/ The presence of any foreign material (e.g., glass, dirt, insert parts, hair, wood, metal, etc.) foreign odor or flavor (e.g., burnt, scorched,

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moldy, rancid, sour, stale, etc.) or foreign color shall be cause for rejection of the lot. (To be determined by a Meat and Poultry Inspection Operations employee or a Poultry Grading Branch representative.)

2/ Product not equal to or better than the approved preproduction sample (see 6.1) in palatability and overall appearance shall be cause for rejection of the lot. (This comparison shall be performed only when deemed necessary by an AMS agent.)

3/ To determine drained weight, the entire contents of each can shall be poured into a suitable container. A minimum of three times the tray pack can's volume of 190° to 212°F water shall be added to the container so as to cover the contents. The product shall be stirred gently to assure the sauce is fully diluted but not undully break up the chicken or vegetables. The diluted sauce shall be decanted through a U.S. Standard 1/4 inch sieve. Any vegetables or chicken on the sieve shall be returned to the mixing container. A volume of tap water equal to the volume of two tray pack cans shall be added to the product. The product shall be stirred gently for approximately 5 seconds. The total contents shall be poured onto a U.S. Standard 1/4 inch sieve and allowed to drain for 2 minutes. The sieve shall be tilted at an approximate 45° angle to facilitate draining. The chicken dices, potato dices, carrot dices and peas shall be manually removed and weighed separately. The drained weight shall be reported to the nearest 0.1 ounce.

4/ Examination for texture conformance of the chicken and vegetable dices shall be made of representative dices immediately following the determination of drained weight.

4.6.3 Fat and salt content testing. Nine tray packs shall be selected from the lot and distributed as follows:

-Three for laboratory analysis.
-Three for submission to the contractor.
-Three for retention by the AMS agent as a reserve sample.

The three tray packs for laboratory analysis shall be individually tested for fat and salt content in accordance with the Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Analytical Chemists, Chapter: Meat and Meat Products, Section: Meat, except that preparation of the samples shall be as

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follows. The three unopened tray packs shall be gently warmed in a water bath to melt fat adhering to the inside of the cans. The cans shall be opened and the entire contents of each can shall be separately blended in a Waring blender or equivalent. The lot shall be rejected if:

a. The average fat content of the three tray packs is greater than 7.0 percent.
b. The fat content in any individual tray pack is greater than 9.0 percent.
c. The salt content in any individual tray pack is greater than 1.0 percent or less than 0.5 percent.

Analysis of reserve samples at the request of the contractor shall not be permitted unless the original laboratory analysis indicated that the involved lot will be rejected because of noncompliance with the fat or salt content requirement. When the reserve sample is analyzed, the analyses for both fat and salt shall be made and will be considered final. Unused reserve samples shall be returned to the contractor for inclusion in subsequent lots.

4.7 Can condition examination. Examination of filled and sealed tray pack cans shall be in accordance with the United States Standards for Condition of Food Containers, except that inspection for labeling shall be in accordance with MIL-L-1497 (see 5.4).

4.8 Shipping container examination. Shipping containers shall be examined for defects in assembly, closure, and reinforcement (when applicable) in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636. In addition, the following defects shall be classified as follows: Major: National stock number, item description, contract number, or date of pack markings missing, incorrect, or illegible. Minor: (1) Other required markings missing, incorrect or illegible; (2) Interior packing with fiberboard liner or pads not as specified; (3) Reinforcement with nonmetallic strapping or tape is not used; (4) Height of box liner less than inside depth dimension of box by more than 1/8 inch or extends above top edge of box; (5) Length or width of pads less than box dimensions by more than 1/8 inch; (6) Arrangement or number of cans not as specified.

4.9 Unit load inspection. Inspection of unit loads shall be in accordance with the quality assurance provisions of MIL-L-35078.

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5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging. The product shall be packaged in accordance with level A or C as specified (see 6.1).

5.1.1 Level A. A size 1001 by 1206 by 200 tray pack can shall be filled with 108 ounces of the food product, sealed and thermoprocessed as specified in 3.4, 3.5, and 3.6. The base plate of the can shall be electrolytic chromium-coated steel and shall be of sufficient temper to protect the product during shipment and storage. The base plate weight of the body and end of each can shall be 90 pounds per base box. The entire inside area of the can shall be coated. Scratches or fractures shall not penetrate through the interior can coating. The interior can coating shall not peel or blister when in contact with the product. The interior can coating shall neither affect nor be affected by the packaged product. A certificate of conformance shall be furnished to certify compliance with the interior can coating requirements. The can shall be coated overall on the outside with a coating conforming to type I of TT-C-495.

5.1.2 Level C. The product shall be packaged as specified in 5.1.1, except that cans with commercial exterior coating will be acceptable.

5.2 Packing. The product shall be packed in accordance with level A, B, or C as specified (see 6.1).

5.2.1 Level A packing. Four cans of product, packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a snug-fitting fiberboard box, constructed, and closed in accordance with style RSC-L, grade V2s of PPP-B-636. The cans shall be packed flat, four in depth within the box. The inside of each box shall be provided with a box liner and five fiberboard pads. The height of the box liner shall be equal to the full inside depth of the box (+0 inch, -1/8 inch). The pads shall be not less than 1/8 inch of the full length and width dimensions of the box and shall be fabricated of grade V3c fiberboard. The pads shall be placed between the cans and on the top and bottom of the stacked cans. Each fiberboard box shall be reinforced with nonmetallic strapping or pressure-sensitive adhesive filament reinforced tape in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636. Shipping containers shall be arranged in unit loads in accordance with MIL-L-35078 for the type and class of load specified (see 6.1). Strapping shall be limited to non-metallic strapping, except for type II, class F loads.

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5.2.2 Level B packing. Four cans of product, packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed as specified in 5.2.1, except the box shall be constructed of grade V3c, V3s or V4s fiberboard.

5.2.3 Level C packing. Four cans of product, packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a snug-fitting fiberboard box, constructed and closed in accordance with style RSC-L, class domestic, grade 275 of PPP-B-636. The cans shall be packed flat, four in depth within the box. The inside of each box shall be provided with a box liner and five fiberboard pads. The height of the box liner shall be equal to the full inside depth of the box (+0 inch, -1/8 inch). The pads shall be placed between the cans and on the top and bottom of the stacked cans. The pad dimensions shall be not less than 1/8 inch of the full length and width dimension of the box and shall be fabricated of the same material as the box.

5.3 Unit loading. When specified (see 6.1), the product, packed as specified in 5.2.2 and 5.2.3, shall be arranged in unit loads in accordance with MIL-L-35078 for the type and class of load specified. When unit loads are strapped, the strapping shall be limited to nonmetallic strapping.

5.4 Labeling. Each tray pack can shall be labeled in accordance with MIL-L-1497. In addition, the name of product shall be marked, stamping is permitted, on one 1001 by 200 side of the can. The labeling shall be legible when examined in accordance with 4.8 after submerging the can in boiling water for 30 minutes. Paper labels are not permitted. Cans shall show the following statements:

TO HEAT

a. To heat in water: Submerge unopened can in boiling water. Simmer gently 35 minutes. Avoid overheating to the point where internal pressure is evident (can shows evidence of bulging). Remove from water and open lid for serving. Caution: Use care when opening as pressure may have been generated within the can.

b. To heat in oven: Either punch several holes in lid of tray can or open can in usual manner leaving the loose lid in place to prevent moisture loss. Place in a 350°F oven for approximately 35 to 40 minutes until contents reach an internal temperature of 165°F.

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WARNING: Do not place closed cans in oven, as heating will increase internal pressure which may cause the can to burst.

YIELD

Approximately ten (10) servings of 1-1/4 cups each.

5.5 Marking.

5.5.1 Shipping containers. In addition to any special marking required by the contract, shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

5.5.2 Unit loads. Unit loads shall be marked in accordance with MIL-L-35078. In addition, the following precautionary markings in capital letters larger than other markings shall be included:

CAUTION: DO NOT STACK PALLETS IN TRANSIT OR MORE THAN TWO HIGH IN STORAGE.

6. NOTES

6.1 Ordering data. Procurement documents should specify the following:

a. Title, number, and date of this specification.
b. When a first article is required (see 3.1, 4.3, and 6.3).
c. Provisions for approved preproduction samples (see 3.6.1 and 6.3).
d. Level of packaging and packing required (see 5.1 and 5.2).
e. Type and class of unit load when unit loading is required (see 5.3).

6.2 Appropriate level of pack. Based on the conditions known or expected to be encountered during shipment, handling and storage of the specific item being procured, the contracting officer should select the appropriate level of pack in accordance with the criteria established in AR 700-15/NAVSUPINST 4030.28/AFR 71-6/MCO 4030.33A/DLAR 4145.7.

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6.3 First article. When a first article is required, it shall be inspected and approved under the appropriate provisions of FAR 52.209-4. The first article should be a preproduction sample. The contracting officer should include specific instructions in all acquisition documents regarding arrangements for selection, inspection, and approval of the first article.

Preparing activity:

Army - GL

Project No. 8940-A443

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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

(See Instructions – Reverse Side)

1. DOCUMENT NUMBER	2. DOCUMENT TITLE
PP-C-002202(Army-GL)	Chicken Stew, Thermostabilized, Tray Pack

3a. NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION	4. TYPE OF ORGANIZATION *(Mark one)*
	☐ VENDOR
	☐ USER
b. ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)*	☐ MANUFACTURER
	☐ OTHER *(Specify)*: _____

5. PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording:

b. Recommended Wording:

c. Reason/Rationale for Recommendation:

6. REMARKS

7a. NAME OF SUBMITTER *(Last, First, MI)* – Optional	b. WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER *(Include Area Code)* – Optional
c. MAILING ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)* – Optional	8. DATE OF SUBMISSION *(YYMMDD)*

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NATICK OP, 1 Apr 84

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